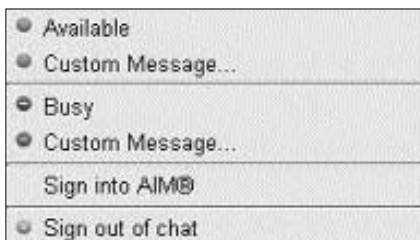


ment Gmail's traditional no-frills ones. Another new feature is the ability to talk with your AIM friends. Click on the inverted triangle beside your name in the chat window and select the "Sign into AIM" to do this.

Gtalk fans have the option of using a Google Talk gadget that can be embedded in Web sites. This widget has tabbed features: in both chat-inside-Gmail as well as in Gtalk, you need to open multiple windows for each conversation. The Talk widget allows you to use tabs such that you don't have to navigate



Log into AIM chat from inside Gmail Chat



Different themes that can be used in Gtalk

around your screen to click on individual conversations. Just hit [Ctrl] + [Tab] to cycle through conversations.

4.1.2 Windows Live Messenger

Windows Live Messenger is the new-age version of the old MSN Messenger, complete with Vista look and feel. All Hotmail, MSN, and Windows Live accounts can be used for logging in. The latest version is 8, which is available for free download at <http://get.live.com/messenger/config>. The installation takes quite a while; you would have to download some critical updates from Microsoft Update before you can start chatting.

WLM (Windows Live Messenger) has refined the basic chat features of its earlier avatar while adding some new ones. The messenger window has a number of vertical tabs, with each tab letting you use a different feature—including News, Dating, Games, and